



Business Analysts

A Business Analyst (BA) in IT project management is the professional who *bridges* the gap between **business needs** and **technical solutions**, ensuring that projects deliver real value to the organization. They focus on *what* should be built and *why*, while project managers focus on *how* and *when*.

Types of Business Analysts

Business Analysts (BAs) are categorized into five specialized types depending on their **organizational focus, responsibilities, and contributions: Strategic, Systems, Process, Data, and Product Bas.**

<u>Type</u>	<u>Focus Area</u>	<u>Example Context</u>
Strategic BA	- Aligns business goals with organizational strategy	Corporate transformation projects
Systems BA	- Bridges business needs and IT systems	ERP or CRM implementation
Process BA	- Optimizes workflows and operations	Lean or Six Sigma initiatives
Data BA	- Analyzes data trends for decision-making	BI dashboards, analytics reports
Product BA	- Defines product requirements and user stories	Agile product development



Roles of a Business Analyst

The roles of a Business Analyst involve acting as a strategic bridge between business and technology teams, serving as a facilitator who coordinates communication and requirements validation, and functioning as an investigator who gathers and interprets business requirements.

Additionally, a BA acts as an advisor who recommends process improvements, a communicator who ensures stakeholder clarity and consensus, and an evaluator who assesses the impact, feasibility, and value of proposed changes.

Needs Identification	→ Understands business problems, pain points, and opportunities.
Requirement Gathering	→ Collects and documents functional and non-functional requirements.
Process Mapping	→ Defines current workflows (AS-IS) and designs improved workflows (TO-BE).
Solution Alignment	→ Ensures technical solutions meet business objectives.
Communication Bridge	→ Translates business language into technical specifications for developers and architects.

<u>Role</u>	<u>Description</u>
Facilitator :	Coordinates communication between stakeholders and technical teams.
Investigator :	Gathers and interprets business requirements through research and analysis.
Advisor :	Recommends process improvements and strategic solutions.
Communicator :	Ensures clarity and consensus among all parties.
Evaluator :	Assesses the impact, feasibility, and value of proposed changes.

- ▶ Bridge between business and technology teams
- ▶ Facilitator of requirements gathering and validation
- ▶ Advisor for process improvement and strategic alignment
- ▶ Communicator ensuring stakeholder clarity and consensus
- ▶ Evaluator of business impact and feasibility



Responsibilities of a Business Analyst

The responsibilities of a Business Analyst include conducting interviews, workshops, and surveys for requirement elicitation; preparing BRDs, FRDs, and SRS documents to define project scope and functionality; and performing SWOT, GAP, and feasibility assessments to identify areas for improvement.

Furthermore, BAs are responsible for validating that solutions meet business and stakeholder expectations, communicating findings, reports, and recommendations to decision-makers, and engaging in continuous improvement by monitoring outcomes and refining processes post-implementation.

- **Requirement Elicitation** : Conduct interviews, workshops, and surveys to gather needs.
- **Documentation** : Prepare BRD, FRD, and SRS to define scope and functionality.
- **Analysis** : Perform SWOT, GAP, and feasibility assessments to identify improvement areas.
- **Validation** : Ensure solutions meet business and stakeholder expectations.
- **Communication** : Present findings, reports, and recommendations to decision-makers.
- **Continuous Improvement** : Monitor outcomes and refine processes post-implementation.



BA Documents and Templates

BAs utilize an essential documentation toolkit comprising the **BRD, FRD, SRS, Use Case Diagrams, User Stories, and Traceability Matrix** to ensure clarity and alignment.

<u>Document</u>	<u>Purpose</u>
BRD (Business Requirements Document)	- Defines business objectives and high-level needs.
FRD (Functional Requirements Document)	- Specifies detailed system functionalities.
SRS (Software Requirements Specification)	- Technical blueprint for developers and testers.
Use Case Diagram	- Visualizes user interactions and system behavior.
User Story Template	- Captures Agile requirements concisely.
Traceability Matrix	- Maps requirements to deliverables for validation.

End-to-end progression covering **Initiation, Planning, Analysis, Design, Implementation, Testing & Validation, and Deployment & Closure**, complete with definitions, key activities, and expected outcomes.

Across phases - **Initiation → Analysis → Design → Testing → Closure** to show how their role spans the entire project.

Continuous Lifecycle Flow:

BRD defines the vision → FRD translates it into functions → SRS provides the technical blueprint → Use Case Diagram visualizes interactions → User Story Template drives Agile execution → Traceability Matrix validates coverage and closes the loop back to BRD.



SWOT & GAP Analysis

They employ analytical frameworks such as **SWOT** and **GAP analysis**, alongside *assessment techniques* like feasibility studies and *risk evaluations*, to drive data-backed decision-making.

SWOT Analysis

SWOT Analysis is a strategic tool used to evaluate the internal and external factors affecting a business or project.

It involves assessing internal advantages such as skills, resources, and reputation (Strengths), alongside internal limitations like budget, time, and capacity (Weaknesses).

Additionally, it examines external growth potential including market trends and technology (Opportunities), as well as external risks such as competition, regulations, and economic shifts (Threats).

<u>Strengths</u>	: Internal advantages (skills, resources, reputation).
<u>Weaknesses</u>	: Internal limitations (budget, time, capacity).
<u>Opportunities</u>	: External growth potential (market trends, technology).
<u>Threats</u>	: External risks (competition, regulation, economy).

GAP Analysis

GAP Analysis is a diagnostic method used to compare the **current state** with the **desired future state**. It identifies missing capabilities, inefficiencies, or performance gaps, guiding roadmap creation for process improvement or system enhancement while ensuring alignment between business goals and operational execution.

- ▶ Identifies missing capabilities, inefficiencies, or performance gaps.
- ▶ Guides roadmap creation for process improvement or system enhancement.
- ▶ Ensures alignment between business goals and operational execution.



🧠 Assessment Techniques Related to Business Analyst 🧠

Assessment techniques related to business analysis include feasibility studies to evaluate the practicality and ROI of proposed solutions, stakeholder analysis to map influence and interest levels, and risk assessments to identify potential project risks and mitigation strategies.

Additionally, they include cost-benefit analysis to quantify value versus investment and performance metrics to define KPIs for success measurement.

Feasibility Study	: Evaluates practicality and ROI of proposed solutions.
Stakeholder Analysis	: Maps influence and interest levels.
Risk Assessment	: Identifies potential project risks and mitigation strategies.
Cost–Benefit Analysis	: Quantifies value versus investment.
Performance Metrics	: Defines KPIs for success measurement.

💡 A **Business Analyst** acts as the **strategic interpreter** between business vision and technical execution. 💡

Through structured documentation, analytical frameworks like **SWOT** and **GAP**, and stakeholder collaboration, BAs ensure that every solution delivers measurable value and aligns with organizational goals.

